

AHSEC 2026 — ENGLISH (36T ENGL)

Fully Solved Paper

SECTION-A: Reading Skill (10 Marks)

(a) What has made life on the Earth possible? (1)

Ans: The environment of the Earth has made the existence, growth and development of all living beings possible.

(b) What are the biotic factors of environment? (2)

Ans: Biotic factors of environment are our surrounding living organisms — such as plants, animals, humans and micro-organisms — which interact with each other and are inseparably bound up with the abiotic (non-living) environment.

(c) What does Environmental Science attempt to study? (2)

Ans: Environmental Science attempts to understand the environment of our planet and the impact of human life on the environment and vice versa; it is also a search for solutions to the major environmental issues confronting us today.

(d) Mention two recent developments in the last few decades that have led to serious environmental problems. (2)

Ans: An abnormal increase in population, and the unplanned and unwise use of mega technology, are two recent developments that have led to serious environmental problems.

(e) Name any two UN-led initiatives to combat the environmental crisis. (2)

Ans: The United Nations Conference on the Human Environment held in Stockholm in June 1972, and the United Nations Conference on Environment and Development held in Rio de Janeiro in 1992 (a third example is the World Summit on Sustainable Development, Johannesburg, 2002).

(f) What is the meaning of the word 'environment'? (1)

Ans: The word 'environment' means surrounding(s).

SECTION-B: Advanced Writing Skills (25 Marks)

Q2. Notice — Inter-college Quiz (5 marks, 50 words)

[NAME OF COLLEGE]

NOTICE

Date: [Date]

INTER-COLLEGE QUIZ COMPETITION

All interested students are hereby informed that an Inter-College Quiz Competition will be held next month. Students keen to represent our college are requested to submit their names to the undersigned by [date]. Limited seats available — register early!

Dibya

Secretary, Debate and Symposium

Q3. Report on Book Fair (10 marks, 100–125 words)

BOOK FAIR ORGANISED BY PUBLICATION BOARD OF ASSAM

[Town], [Date]: A Book Fair was recently organised in our town by the Publication Board of Assam, in which a large number of publishing houses from across the State participated with great enthusiasm.

The fair, inaugurated by a noted litterateur, displayed a wide array of books ranging from academic and reference titles to Assamese literature, poetry and children's books, all available at attractive discounts. Special stalls dedicated to regional authors drew huge crowds of students, teachers and book-lovers throughout the

event. Cultural programmes including book-reading sessions and interactions with authors were also organised to promote reading habits among the youth.

The event was widely appreciated for its contribution to promoting Assamese literature and literacy, and the organisers announced plans to make it an annual event.

Q4. Job Application with Biodata — Assistant Teacher (10 marks)

From:

Aruna/Arun

[Address]

[Date]

To

The Principal

Modern High School, Goalpara

Subject: Application for the post of Assistant Teacher

Sir/Madam,

In response to your advertisement for the post of Assistant Teacher in your esteemed institution, I wish to apply for the same. I am confident that my qualifications and enthusiasm for teaching make me a suitable candidate for this position. My biodata is enclosed for your kind perusal.

I would be grateful if I could be granted an opportunity for an interview.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,

Aruna/Arun

BIODATA

Name: Aruna/Arun

Father's/Mother's Name: [Name]

Date of Birth: [DOB]

Address: [Address]

Contact No.: [Phone] | Email: [Email]

Educational Qualifications:

- B.Ed., [University], [Year]
- Graduation (B.A./B.Sc.), [University], [Year]
- Higher Secondary (AHSEC), [Year]

Experience: [Mention any prior teaching experience, if applicable]

Languages Known: English, Hindi, Assamese

Declaration: I hereby declare that the above particulars are true to the best of my knowledge.

Date: [Date]

Signature: Aruna/Arun

SECTION-C: Grammar (20 Marks)

Q5. Narration (any two) (2×2=4)

(a) The boy said to the teacher, "Sir, I am weak in English and seek your advice."

Ans: The boy respectfully told the teacher that he was weak in English and sought his advice.

(c) She said to me, "How long will you stay here?" I replied that I would stay for a week.

Ans: She asked me how long I would stay there, and I replied that I would stay for a week.

Q6. Voice change (any three) ($1 \times 3 = 3$)

(a) He likes tea.

Ans: Tea is liked by him.

(d) The gardener is watering the plants.

Ans: The plants are being watered by the gardener.

(e) English is spoken all over the world.

Ans: People speak English all over the world.

(f) An earthquake destroyed the town.

Ans: The town was destroyed by an earthquake.

Q7. Correct verb forms (any five) ($1 \times 5 = 5$)

(a) I wish I _____ (know) her.

Ans: knew

(b) The First World War _____ (last) for four years and ended in 1918.

Ans: lasted

(c) I usually _____ (start) for school at 8 o'clock.

Ans: start

(e) The match _____ (begin) before we reached the stadium.

Ans: had begun

(f) She _____ (work) in our office since 2022.

Ans: has been working

Q8. Prepositions (any four) ($1 \times 4 = 4$)

(a) She will come to our town _____ a week.

Ans: in

(c) He is confident _____ success.

Ans: of

(d) The old woman has no one to look _____ her.

Ans: after

(e) Butter is made _____ milk.

Ans: from

Q9. Rewrite as directed (any four) ($1 \times 4 = 4$)

(a) Only Anita can do this. (negative, same meaning)

Ans: None but Anita can do this.

(b) She hoped that she would do well in the competition. (simple sentence)

Ans: She hoped to do well in the competition.

(d) Kolkata is the most populous city in India. (comparative degree)

Ans: Kolkata is more populous than any other city in India.

(g) We often go there every winter, _____? (question tag)

Ans: don't we?

SECTION-D: Textbooks (45 Marks)

Q10(a). Extract from 'My Mother at Sixty-Six'

(i) Name the poet. (1)

Ans: Kamala Das.

(ii) When did the poet observe her mother? (1)

Ans: She observed her mother while driving from her parents' home to Cochin last Friday morning.

(iii) What did the poet observe about her mother's face? (2)

Ans: She observed that her mother, dozing beside her with her mouth open, had a face that looked pale and ashen like that of a corpse — making the poet painfully realise that her mother had grown as old as she looked.

Q11. Answer any three in 30–40 words (2×3=6)

(a) Why has the mother been compared to a late winter's moon?

Ans: The mother has been compared to a late winter's moon because, like the pale, waning moon losing its brightness, her ageing face looked pale, faded and lifeless — symbolising her declining health and nearness to death.

(b) What are the 'merry children spilling out of their homes' symbolic of?

Ans: They are symbolic of youthful energy, vitality, hope and the continuity of life, standing in sharp contrast to the poet's fear about her mother's ageing and approaching mortality.

(f) Name some of the things the roadside stand offered for sale.

Ans: The roadside stand offered wild berries for sale in the summer and squashes (a kind of vegetable/gourd) in the fall.

Q12. Answer any five (1×5=5)

(a) What is the most beautiful language in the world, according to M. Hamel?

Ans: According to M. Hamel, French is the most beautiful language in the world — the clearest and the most logical.

(b) What did M. Hamel write at the end of the class?

Ans: M. Hamel wrote "Viva La France!" (Long Live France!) on the blackboard before dismissing the class.

(c) Who is the 'Chota Sahib' in 'Memoirs of a Chota Sahib'?

Ans: The 'Chota Sahib' is the author himself, John Rowntree, a young British forest officer serving in Assam.

(d) Name the book from which 'Memoirs of a Chota Sahib' is taken.

Ans: It is taken from 'A Chota Sahib: Memoirs of a Forest Officer' by John Rowntree.

(e) What does Mukesh want to be?

Ans: Mukesh wants to become a motor mechanic, breaking away from his family's traditional, hazardous bangle-making occupation.

(f) What does Saheb look for in the garbage dumps?

Ans: Saheb looks for anything of value he can sell for money, and sometimes he finds a coin or two among the garbage, which raises his hope of finding something more valuable.

(g) Who is Sir Edward Gait?

Ans: Sir Edward Gait was a British civil servant (ICS officer) and historian, best known as the author of 'A History of Assam', an important historical work on the region.

(h) Which country had developed synthetic indigo?

Ans: Germany had developed synthetic indigo.

(i) Who is the writer of 'Going Places'?

Ans: A.R. Barton is the writer of 'Going Places'.

Q13. Answer any five in 30–40 words (2×5=10)

(b) How was M. Hamel dressed on the day of the last lesson?

Ans: M. Hamel was dressed in his best Sunday clothes — a beautiful green coat, a frilled shirt, and a little black silk embroidered cap — clothes he normally wore only on inspection or prize days, in honour of his last French class.

(c) What does John Rowntree say about the importance of Guwahati? Is the statement true in our time as well?

Ans: Rowntree describes Guwahati as an important administrative and trading hub of Assam, a gateway to the region. Yes, the statement holds true even today, as Guwahati remains the largest city and commercial gateway of Northeast India.

(e) Is Saheb happy working at the tea stall? Explain.

Ans: No, Saheb is not truly happy. Although he earns more money at the tea stall than as a ragpicker, he has lost the freedom he once had; the steel canister he carries seems heavier than his earlier garbage bag, weighing on his spirit as much as his hand.

(g) Why was the Champaran episode so significant in Gandhi's political career?

Ans: The Champaran episode was significant because it was Gandhi's first major act of civil disobedience in India, establishing satyagraha as an effective method of non-violent resistance and bringing him recognition as a leader who fought for the rights of the common people.

(h) Why was Gandhi impressed with Rajkumar Shukla?

Ans: Gandhi was impressed by Rajkumar Shukla's simplicity, persistence and unwavering determination — despite being poor and unlettered, Shukla doggedly followed Gandhi from place to place until he agreed to visit Champaran and see the peasants' plight for himself.

(i) Did Sophie really meet Danny Casey? Which was the only occasion when she got to see Casey in person?

Ans: No, Sophie never actually had a personal relationship with Danny Casey; it existed only in her imagination. The only occasion she got to see him in person was when he came to the cobbler's shop where she worked, to get his football boots mended.

Q14. Answer any one in 80–100 words (1×5=5)

(b) How did the Champaran episode change the plight of the peasants?

Ans: Before Gandhi's intervention, the indigo sharecroppers of Champaran were bound under the exploitative Tinkathia system, forced by British planters to grow indigo on three-twentieths of their land and sell it at unfairly low, planter-fixed prices. When Germany developed synthetic indigo, the planters, instead of releasing the farmers, extracted heavy illegal compensation from them for freeing them from their contracts. Gandhi arrived at the request of Rajkumar Shukla and began methodically recording peasants' statements despite official opposition, even facing a court summons which he refused to obey. His firm yet non-violent resistance forced the government to appoint an inquiry committee, on which Gandhi served. The peasants' fear was replaced with a sense of empowerment as they finally found their voice. As a result, a settlement was reached: the planters had to refund 25 per cent of the money illegally taken, and the unjust Tinkathia system was abolished altogether.

Q15. Answer any one in 125–150 words (7 marks)

(a) Draw a character sketch of the Tiger King in your own words.

Ans: The Tiger King, Maharaja Jung Jung Bahadur of Pratibandapuram, is a proud, stubborn and superstitious ruler whose entire life is shaped by a childhood prophecy that he would one day be killed by the hundredth tiger he tried to hunt. Determined to defy fate, he embarks on an obsessive mission to kill a hundred tigers, revealing both his arrogance and his deep insecurity. He is autocratic and ruthless in exercising power — he threatens to dismiss the state astrologer, marries strategically to gain access to more tigers in his in-laws' kingdom, and even

risks the wrath of the British government by refusing a wealthy dewan's gift, only to bribe a high-ranking British officer with gifts worth fifty thousand rupees to protect his throne when tigers grow scarce in his own kingdom. When live tigers run out, he resorts to hunting an old, infirm one to complete his tally, illustrating his obsession with the prophecy over genuine courage. Ironically, despite avoiding death from ninety-nine tigers and a doubtful hundredth kill, he dies from a blood infection caused by a splinter from a wooden toy tiger — proving that fate cannot be outwitted, and exposing the story's satire on human vanity, superstition, and the arrogance of unchecked royal power.

Q16. Answer any four in 30–40 words (2×4=8)

(a) What did the chief astrologer predict about the Tiger King?

Ans: The chief astrologer predicted that the Tiger King's death would come from a tiger — specifically, that when he grew up and began hunting tigers, his death would occur at the very moment he killed the hundredth tiger.

(b) How did the hundredth tiger take its revenge on the Tiger King?

Ans: Though the Maharaja believed he had shot the hundredth tiger dead (it was actually only stunned by the shock of the gunfire and later killed by villagers), fate caught up with him when a splinter from a wooden toy tiger, bought for his son, caused an infection in his hand that eventually led to his death — the hundredth tiger's true revenge.

(c) Why did Zitkala-Sa feel uncomfortable in the dining room?

Ans: Zitkala-Sa felt uncomfortable because of the strange, rigid customs of the dining room — a loud bell signalled meal times, and everyone was expected to sit up straight and follow strict, unfamiliar rules of table etiquette, very different from her free, natural upbringing.

(g) What is the difference between a Meji and a Bhelaghar?

Ans: A Meji is a bonfire or pyre made of firewood, hay and bamboo that is ceremonially burnt on the morning of Magh Bihu (Uruka), while a Bhelaghar is a temporary hut built of hay, bamboo and thatch during the same festival, in which people spend the Uruka night, and which is also set on fire the next morning along with the Meji.